Walkthrough
Greenup County Schools
Report

engagement. questioning. discussion

Teacher(s)
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Observer
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Date & Time
1/25/2017 & 8:06:00 AM

Grade
7th Grade

Subject
Language Arts

Location of adults
Circulating around the room.

Is there a congruent match between learning targets and instructional activities and/or assessments?
Yes

Standard addressed in class:
R 7.9 Comparing and Constrasting between two different texts.

Teacher maximizes use of instructional time:
Agree

Explanation of use of instructional time:
Started the lesson with the vocabulary flashbacksandthen transitioned into a quiz on educaplay.

Was student work displayed with rubric or target?
Yes

Comments on student work:
Displayed on the backboard.

Does the lesson plan match current teaching and appropriate content?
Yes, evidence

Comments on lesson plan matching current teaching:
Lesson pan matches current teaching

Use of technology:
Teacher use

Comments on technology usage:
Teacher is using the smartboard for display as well as for the quiz

Instructional Practice(s):
Oral presentation, Small group instruction

Does lesson plan reflect evidence of before, during, and after reading strategies?
Yes

Student grouping:
Small group, Independent

Percentage of students actively engaged:
76 - 100%

How students were engaged:
THey were all answering the questions, but as the time went on it was clear that their engagement was starting to slack.

Professional learning witnessed:
Quality questioning

Communicating:
3: Accomplished - Clear directions and procedures. Explanation of content is well scaffolded. During explanation, student engagement is invited. Teacher's language is clear, correct, and uses appropriate vocabulary.

Suggestions for improving communication:
You communicate your directions and procedures very well. I do not hear content mistakes when you give explanation. Student engagement was invited in the form of displaying the white boards with the answers to the online quiz.

Questioning and discussion:
2: Developing - Questions lead to a single path of inquiry, predetermined answers, some questions and discussion prompts promote thinking but only a few students involved

Suggestions for improving discussion:
REally liked the use of the mini whiteboards for the quiz. However giving feedback immediately after the question is asked would be more effective. Instead of just reading the question and having them put up the answer. Tell them after they have answered what the correct answer was and why. It would be more effective feedback that way and also it would

take less time. The online quiz consumed half of the lesson. Also there was little opportunity for student discussion or input. They sat compliantly and answered the questions.

Engaging students in learning:

2: Developing - Learning task and activities are partially aligned and require minimal thinking, pacing of lesson is inadequate

Suggestions for improving engagement:

Students are all answering the question s they are required to with the mini whiteboards which allows for a high degree of engagement. However, the quiz was a little too long to be given in that manner. It was over 20 minutes in duration and then another 10 going over the questions again with feedback. Even though the students were continuing to answer the questions, after about 10 or max fifteen minutes you should transition to another activity. Maybe shorten it and select five to 10 most effective questions. Though they were all answering and your questions were aligned the time messed with the pacing of the lesson.

Using assessment in instruction:

3: Accomplished - Assessment used regularly by teacher and student to monitor learning and provide specific feedback, students are aware of assessment criteria and some engage in self-assessment

Suggestions for improving assessment:

The online quiz that the students use the mini whiteboards for is a form of formative assessment which they are getting immediate feedback on. Also the flashback vocabulary activities are formative assessments that are checked through grade cam.

Overall observation:

You are very strong procedurally and in giving clear directions. It is also clear that you have over planned for this lesson, which is not a bad thing at all. However I would caution you on using the online quiz. Those are good for quick and brief activities to quickly assess a skill or concept. That was not quick and I fear that the wordiness of some of the questions may have lessened the desired impact of the quiz. I suggest shortening the quiz and choosing questions for their overall impact on the desired learning outcomes. Also in order to make your pod brainstorming more effective, it might be a good ide to assign roles to each group member and then have them rotate. Such as recorder, generator, questioner, feedback etc.